

MacroLens Daily Brief — July 31, 2026

Automated macro briefing generated by MacroLens AI

Top Headlines

1. Trump convenes Cabinet at Camp David amid simmering Iran war - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-31 10:24

Trump convenes Cabinet at Camp David amid simmering Iran war tensions, a geopolitical risk factor that could impact oil prices and broader market sentiment.

2. Oil rises over 1% as traders assess shipping flows; monthly gains in sight - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-31 03:00

Oil rises over 1% as traders assess shipping flows, with monthly gains in sight, reflecting supply chain disruptions and geopolitical risk premiums.

3. The S&P 500 is stuck at a key battleground level. This obscure index could determine the market's next move

CNBC — 2026-07-31 18:07

The S&P 500 is stuck at 7,500, a key battleground; a break below 7,450 could trigger a larger downside move, while rising implied correlation suggests a more balanced but fragile market.

4. Andy Jassy soothed concerns over Amazon's massive AI spending. Here's how he did it

CNBC — 2026-07-31 18:34

Amazon CEO Andy Jassy soothed concerns over massive AI spending, likely reassuring investors about the company's capital expenditure plans and supporting its stock.

5. New York sues Kalshi, says prediction market is running 'illegal gambling operation'

CNBC — 2026-07-31 12:41

New York sued prediction market Kalshi, alleging illegal gambling; the state seeks a permanent injunction and up to \$36 billion in penalties, creating regulatory uncertainty for the platform.

6. British Airways-owner IAG trims capacity outlook; jet fuel bill eases - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-31 06:05

British Airways-owner IAG trimmed its capacity outlook while jet fuel costs eased, a mixed signal for airline margins and earnings.

7. **Illicit Iranian gambling network helped pull off a \$4 billion sanctions dodge - Reuters**

Reuters — 2026-07-31 08:54

An illicit Iranian gambling network helped dodge \$4 billion in sanctions, highlighting geopolitical financial risks that could affect oil markets and sanctions enforcement.

8. **Microsoft shares are surging. Here's how to still make money, says Mike Khouw**

CNBC — 2026-07-31 15:26

Microsoft shares surged after Q4 earnings; a suggested options trade (short strangle) offers ~1.6% return in 21 days, capitalizing on post-earnings volatility crush.

9. **IBM CEO says quantum computing will have a 'measurable impact' on earnings by 2028 or 2029**

CNBC — 2026-07-30 22:46

IBM CEO says quantum computing will have a measurable earnings impact by 2028-2029; shares remain down 25% from July earnings, with 40% of delayed deals already closing.

10. **Fintech broker Clear Street offers investors pre-IPO access to \$188 billion AI giant Databricks**

CNBC — 2026-07-31 18:20

Clear Street is launching a platform for accredited investors to access pre-IPO shares of Databricks (valued at \$188 billion) via SPVs, though Databricks has no direct relationship with the firm.

Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	741.69	+1.68%	bullish
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	683.55	+3.30%	bullish
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	521.51	+1.18%	bullish
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	292.59	+1.39%	bullish
XLK	Technology ETF	175.73	+5.50%	bullish
XLF	Financials ETF	57.00	+0.56%	bullish
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	82.01	+0.02%	neutral

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	93.21	+0.04%	neutral
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	82.80	-0.06%	neutral
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	106.41	+0.18%	neutral
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	79.47	+0.29%	neutral
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	377.16	+1.64%	bullish
SLV	Silver ETF	53.50	+3.34%	bullish
USO	Oil ETF	127.48	-1.42%	bearish
UNG	Natural Gas ETF	10.01	+0.81%	bullish
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	28.14	-0.99%	bearish
FXE	Euro ETF	106.47	+0.73%	bullish
FXJ	Japanese Yen ETF	57.58	+2.58%	bullish
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	64725.31	+1.28%	bullish
ETH-USD	Ethereum	1917.37	+0.46%	neutral

Key Macro Indicators

Indicator	Value	As Of
Fed Funds Rate Target	3.5% – 3.75%	2026-07-31
10Y Breakeven Inflation (%)	2.28	2026-07-31
10Y-2Y Yield Spread (bp)	0.47	2026-07-31
VIX	17.09	2026-07-30
USD Index (Broad)	120.7105	2026-07-24

Major Anomalies

XLK — Technology ETF +5.50%

Cause: Tech sector outperformance due to Amazon's AI spending comments and Databricks pre-IPO hype.

Forward Impact: Momentum could persist, but valuation concerns and market breadth may limit upside.

SLV — Silver ETF +3.34%

Cause: Silver rally likely tied to weaker dollar and safe-haven demand amid market uncertainty.

Forward Impact: May see further gains if dollar weakness persists, but industrial demand and Fed policy will be key.

QQQ — Nasdaq 100 ETF +3.30%

Cause: Broad tech rally driven by Amazon's reassurance on AI spending and positive sentiment from Databricks pre-IPO access.

Forward Impact: Likely to continue if tech earnings remain strong, but may face resistance at key S&P 500 battleground level.

FXJ — Japanese Yen ETF +2.58%

Cause: Yen strength likely from safe-haven flows and expectations of BOJ policy normalization.

Forward Impact: Could appreciate further if global risk-off continues, but intervention risk and rate differentials may cap gains.

Macro Data Releases — Today

[Calendar error: 403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: <https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?from=2026-07-31&to=2026-08-08&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong>]

Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

No upcoming macro events in the next 7 days.

Sector Heat Map

Sector Performance Heatmap			
	1D	5D	1M
Energy	+0.5%	-0.7%	+11.0%
Financials	+0.6%	+2.1%	+6.3%
Healthcare	-1.6%	+1.3%	+3.1%
Consumer Staples	-2.2%	+2.7%	+2.9%
Real Estate	-1.4%	+0.8%	+2.9%
Materials	-0.2%	+2.7%	+1.6%
Communication Services	-2.7%	+1.1%	-0.5%
Utilities	-0.6%	-3.3%	-1.5%
Industrials	+1.0%	-1.9%	-3.7%
Consumer Discretionary	+0.7%	+3.3%	-4.2%
Technology	+5.5%	-1.5%	-7.8%

Hot Now

- **Energy** — Energy shows strong 1-month momentum (+11%) despite short-term pullback, indicating sustained demand and supply concerns.
- **Financials** — Financials exhibit consistent gains across 1-day, 5-day, and 1-month, benefiting from higher interest rates and robust economic activity.

Cold but Worth Watching

- **Technology** — Technology has fallen sharply over the past month (-7.8%) but saw a strong 1-day bounce (+5.5%), suggesting potential oversold conditions and a possible reversal.
- **Consumer Discretionary** — Consumer Discretionary has declined over the month (-4.2%) but shows recent strength (5d +3.3%), indicating improving consumer sentiment and potential for recovery.

Momentum is favoring cyclical and rate-sensitive sectors like Energy and Financials, while oversold growth sectors like Technology and Consumer Discretionary may be poised for mean-reversion.

Daily Conclusion

Risk appetite is rotating away from crowded tech leadership into cyclical value plays like energy and financials, as geopolitical headlines—rather than economic data—drive a defensive, sector-rotation trade.

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